

## Shellshock—the latest threat to Linux and Mac OS X systems

The newly identified ‘Shellshock’ computer bug has already been exploited by hackers. A warning on this subject has been issued by researchers. ‘Shellshock’ is the first major Internet threat since the discovery of Heartbleed in April 2014, which affected OpenSSL encryption software. Several attacks took advantage of a long-existent but undiscovered vulnerability in the Linux and Mac tool, Bash.

With this malware, hackers trick Web servers into running any command that follows a carefully crafted series of characters in an http request. Thousands of machines can be attacked with this malware as it’s

designed to make the machines part of a botnet of computers that easily come under the influence of hackers’ commands. In at least one case, the attacked machines also launched distributed denial of service attacks that delivered a huge volume of junk traffic, as per security researchers.

**Shellshock vulnerability exploits NAS devices:** A recent report by FireEye reveals that the Shellshock vulnerability is spreading to NAS devices as well, which was first reported on September 24 of this year in the Bourne Again Shell (Bash). The report also states that the attackers are trying to exploit a code to hack into personal data. QNAP has pushed a security patch to fix it.

**Attackers target Yahoo, Winzip and Lycos:** According to the latest news from Yahoo, its servers were hacked by attackers from Romania. The company confirms that the Shellshock security hole was targeted by the attackers. Yahoo also said that there has been no loss of user data so far. Malicious scripts can be run on Bash if the Shellshock vulnerability is exploited. Since Bash runs commands on the system, hackers get direct access to the core system codes.

**Red Hat and Apple release revised versions of patches against Shellshock:** Mac, Linux and UNIX users can breathe a sigh of relief as the latest revisions of the bug fixes against Shellshock have been released by Apple and Red Hat. Apple has noted that a few Macs have been impacted by the bug and most users are already protected. The company had already promised that they will release an update shortly to address the issue. For older versions of OS X, there are separate downloads for Lion and Mountain Lion. The patch will be available through an OS X software update mechanism too.



### Red Hat breaks traditional storage barriers with open software-defined storage for multi-petabyte scale capacity

Red Hat has announced the availability of the newest major release of Red Hat Storage Server, an industry-leading open software-defined storage solution for scale-out file storage. The advanced capabilities in Red Hat Storage 3 are well-suited for data-intensive enterprise workloads including big data, operational analytics, and enterprise file sharing and collaboration. With its proven and validated workload solutions, Red Hat Storage Server 3 enables enterprises to curate enterprise data to increase responsiveness, control costs and improve operational efficiency. Red Hat is committed to building agile storage solutions through community-driven innovation to drive agility within the enterprise so as to better respond to competitive threats and changes in the evolving IT landscape. Based on the open source GlusterFS 3.6

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file system and Red Hat Enterprise Linux 6, Red Hat Storage Server 3 is designed to easily scale to support petabytes of data and offer granular control of your storage environment while lowering the overall cost of storage.

### GNOME 3.14 not to be part of Ubuntu 14.10

The GNOME 3.14 desktop will not be a part of Ubuntu 14.10, which is all set to be released on October 23 this year. If you have been wondering about this decision, then Ubuntu GNOME developer Ali Linx offered the following explanation in OMG! Ubuntu!: “Ubuntu, as all of you may know, has a strict schedule and something called ‘feature freeze.’” One of the most common